NAT OTA Booking Flow (OCTO API)

How an OTA booking travels through the OCTO API and is created in the NAT Booking Software

1. Online Travel Agency (OTA)

Headout

CHD

Any OTA that supports OCTO

Customer books a tour

- Searches tour, date and guests
- Clicks Book and enters details
- Pays on the OTA
- **OTA creates and confirms its booking**

Confirmation email sent to customer
By the OTA, with the ticket

1 Availability check
Tour, date, guests
Seats and prices

2 Create booking
Hold the seats
On hold + booking ID

3 Confirm booking
After the OTA confirms, with customer details
Reply: confirmed

2. OCTO API (Booking Connection)

OCTO
Travel industry booking standard

- Connects OTAs directly to NAT
- Secure key for each OTA
- Carries every step: availability, create, confirm
- Carries changes and cancellations

1 Availability check
Passed to NAT
Live availability

2 Create booking
Passed to NAT
Seats held

3 Confirm booking
Passed to NAT
Reply: confirmed
e.g. HEAD-12345

3. NAT Booking Software

- Checks cutoff time and guest limits
- Creates the booking ON HOLD for a set time (usually 30 min)
- After confirm, creates the booking CONFIRMED
- Shows it on the dashboard and OTA report
- Processes changes and cancellations
- Releases seats if the hold expires

Check and lock seats

4. Inventory & Tour Products

- Tour dates and times
- Live seats on each tour
- Prices for adult, child, infant
- Seats go HELD then BOOKED
- Same seat count for every OTA

Booked

5. Booking Ready in NAT

- Confirmed booking with the OTA's reference, e.g. HEAD-12345
- Shows on your dashboard and OTA report
- Your team sees the guests, date and time
- Changes and cancellations come in through OCTO

Inventory Updates
(real-time)

1 Customer Books on OTA

- Selects tour, date and guests
- Clicks Book and enters details

2 Availability via OCTO

- OTA sends an availability check
- NAT checks seats, cutoff and guest limits
- Seats and prices sent back

3 Seats Held in NAT

- OTA sends Create booking via OCTO
- NAT creates the booking on hold
- Seats locked for a set time, usually 30 minutes, or as the client requests

4 OTA Confirms & Emails

- Customer pays on the OTA
- OTA creates and confirms its booking
- OTA emails the confirmation and ticket to the customer

5 Confirmed in NAT via OCTO

- OTA passes the confirmation to NAT via OCTO
- NAT creates the confirmed booking and replies: confirmed
- Changes and cancellations follow the same OCTO flow

If the OTA doesn't confirm within the hold time, the booking expires and the seats go back on sale.